

Medication Administration and Pain Reassessment Standard Operating Procedure

SOP Number: MED-ADMIN-2024-012

Effective Date: January 15, 2024

Last Revised: August 2024

Scope: Nursing staff administering opioid and analgesic medications

Purpose

This SOP establishes standardized procedures for the safe administration of opioid and non-opioid analgesic medications, with emphasis on pain assessment, appropriate documentation, and verification of provider orders to ensure patient safety and regulatory compliance.

Pain Assessment and Documentation Requirements

Pre-Administration Assessment (Prior to Medication Dispensing)

Mandatory: All opioid medications MUST have documented evidence of clinical justification prior to administration, including pain assessment and patient complaint. **Step 1: Assess Patient Pain Level**

- Obtain current pain score using facility-approved pain scale (0-10 numeric rating scale)
- Document pain location, quality, and duration
- Assess impact on function and patient goals
- Record assessment in Epic at Time = Admission/Latest Assessment

Pain Score Documentation Requirements:

Opioid Type	Minimum Pre-Admin Pain Score	Documentation Required
All Schedule II opioids (morphine, fentanyl, hydromorphone)	Pain score 4 or greater, OR documented clinical reason	Pain reassessment within 30 min pre-administration
Schedule III/IV opioids (codeine, tramadol)	Pain score 3 or greater OR documented reason (preventive pre-procedure)	Pain reassessment or clinical note within 1 hour
Opioids for palliative/end-of-life care	Clinical judgment; may vary based on goals of care	Documented palliative care plan in chart

Verification of Provider Order

Step 2: Verify Provider Order

- Confirm provider order exists in Epic before medication dispensing
- Verify order date and time is PRIOR to administration time
- Check medication name, dose, route, and frequency match order exactly
- Confirm order has not been cancelled or discontinued
- If discrepancy exists, STOP and contact provider immediately

Critical Safety Rule: Do not administer any medication without a valid, active provider order dated PRIOR to administration. Administration before order documentation is a medication error.

Post-Administration Pain Reassessment

Step 3: Post-Administration Follow-up

1. Reassess pain score 30-60 minutes after opioid administration
2. Document post-administration pain score in Epic
3. Note pain relief achieved and any adverse effects
4. If pain remains above goal, contact provider for additional interventions

Documentation Template in Epic Nursing Note:

Pre-Admin Assessment: Pain 7/10, right shoulder, sharp quality, limiting arm movement
Order Verified: Morphine 4 mg IV q4h ordered 0730 by Dr. Smith, active order confirmed in Epic
Administration: Morphine 4 mg IV administered 0745 in right antecubital fossa
Post-Admin (0815): Pain reassessment 3/10, patient reports excellent relief, able to perform PT exercises
Witness (if applicable): Jane Doe, RN, observed administration

Deviation and Exception Handling

When Pain Score Does Not Support Opioid Administration:

If patient pain score is below threshold for opioid (e.g., pain 2/10 but provider ordered morphine):

1. Contact ordering provider BEFORE administration
2. Verify clinical reason (e.g., preventive pre-procedure medication)
3. If provider confirms order despite low pain score, document provider's clinical justification in Epic
4. Proceed with administration only after documented justification

When Provider Order Cannot Be Located:

1. Contact ordering provider to confirm order placement
2. Do not administer from memory or standing orders
3. Wait for order entry in Epic before dispensing
4. Document communication with provider and time order was placed

Audit and Monitoring

The Diversion Support Team will monitor medication administration records for:

- Opioid administrations lacking pre-admin pain documentation
- Administration times before documented provider order times
- Missing post-admin pain reassessment
- Inconsistent pain documentation patterns by provider

References

- Joint Commission standards on pain management and medication safety
- Institute for Safe Medication Practices (ISMP) guidelines
- DEA Pharmacy Compliance requirements
- St. Luke's Pain Management Policy
- Epic Medication Administration Module Training Manual

SOP Approved By: Chief Nursing Officer, Pharmacy Director, Medical Staff Leadership

This is a synthetic sample document created for training and demonstration purposes.